

DAMON VERSAGGI

CREATIVE DIRECTOR | CREATIVE TECHNOLOGIST | INTERACTIVE EXPERIENCE LEADER

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Creative Director and Creative Technologist building interactive experiences, real-time 3D systems, broadcast graphics, immersive media, AI products, and original IP across sports, news, entertainment, and consumer experiences. Bridges creative direction, product thinking, and technical delivery from concept and prototype through launch-critical live production.

CORE EXPERTISE

Creative Direction • Creative Technology • Interactive Experience Design • Real-Time 3D • Broadcast Graphics • AI-Assisted Product • XR / WebXR • Experiential & Spatial Design • Product Prototyping • Creative Systems • Team Leadership • Client & Executive Presentations

SELECTED CAREER IMPACT

- **New Year's Rockin' Eve:** 15 years across graphics, creative direction, and live production; redesigned the midnight countdown treatment in 2011, creating a visual foundation for the show presentation that followed.
- **NBA Finals + ESPN:** contributed to season packages, live game graphics systems, operator training, and high-pressure broadcast execution.
- **Fox Business Network + CBS HD:** contributed to launch-critical real-time graphics platforms where visual craft, reliability, and technical execution were inseparable.
- **Scrappy Meals XR / Fridgie Smalls:** built original IP, WebXR worlds, interactive 3D, and AI products from the ground up; Fridgie grew to nearly 20,000 users while reducing input-token usage 72%, cutting tokens per call roughly 40%, and improving response speed by about two seconds.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Creative Director | Damon Versaggi Consulting 2015 - Present

- Lead creative direction and technology work across broadcast, sports, interactive, immersive, real-time, and emerging-media experiences.
- Translate audience goals and creative concepts into visual systems, prototypes, production workflows, and launch-ready experiences.
- Work across designers, technologists, producers, clients, and executives from discovery and pitch through build, launch, and iteration.

Founder / Creative Director | Scrappy Meals XR / Fridgie Smalls 2016 - Present

- Created a founder-led ecosystem spanning live food experiences, original characters, children's storytelling, WebXR, interactive 3D, AI products, and entertainment.
- Developed The Metacheese, a browser-based WebXR environment combining interactive 3D, remote participation, virtual readings, and content production.
- Built Fridgie Smalls, a mobile-first AI recipe experience that turns available ingredients into recipes, substitutions, grocery support, and saved cookbook content.
- Extended the product into FRIDGIE x SCRAPS*, a character-driven children's entertainment system using AI-assisted production, continuity controls, and reusable creative assets.

VP, Sales & Technology | eFundex 2024 - Present

Creative Technology Consultant | SwivelMeta 2022

- Consulted on interactive Web3 experiences connecting digital worlds with Outernet London's large-scale physical and digital environment, linking concept, platform, audience participation, and destination experience.

DAMON VERSAGGI | CREATIVE DIRECTION + TECHNOLOGY + EXPERIENCE

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Production Manager, Real-Time Systems | Tribune Media / PIX11 / WGN 2012 - 2015

- Led production-focused real-time systems work in live broadcast environments spanning news, elections, graphics, and control-room operations.

Creative Technologist, Internal Multi-Touch | Lockheed Martin

- Created graphics for a classified internal touchscreen initiative designed to relay changing operational data clearly inside a multi-touch environment.
- Balanced information density, hierarchy, and rapid comprehension for role-based operational and decision-support views; specific program details and interface content remain classified.

Creative Systems / Real-Time Graphics Lead | SportsNet New York 2008 - 2012

- Helped develop a new visual direction spanning broadcast and stadium graphics for SNY / New York Mets, including shaping and presenting the redesign directly to Mets ownership.
- Worked across real-time graphics, creative systems, live sports storytelling, and production workflows.

Solutions Architect | Vizrt 2004 - 2008

- Delivered real-time graphics and creative-technology solutions across sports and news broadcast environments, including launch-critical platform work for Fox Business Network and CBS HD.
- Supported NBA Finals and ESPN work spanning graphics packages, live systems, operator training, and high-pressure broadcast execution.

SELECTED INTERACTIVE, IMMERSIVE & LIVE WORK

- **Interactive Elections, 2004 - 2020:** translated fast-changing, high-volume election data into real-time visual experiences presenters could explore live and audiences could understand, combining data, 3D graphics, interaction design, presenter workflows, and control-room reliability.
- **ESPN Around the Horn x Girraphic:** built and installed the graphics and production workflow connecting ESPN's Seaport control room in New York with the host in Washington, D.C., creating an immediate and reliable split-location live experience.
- **SNY / New York Mets:** helped develop and pitch a visual direction spanning television and in-stadium graphics, including a direct presentation to Mets owner Fred Wilpon.
- **Strevi, Italy:** selected for a competitive artist residency on the strength of Scrappy Meals and XR work; built an immersive interpretation of a Mother Cabrini statue through digital 3D, spatial storytelling, and audience interaction.
- **Scrappyhour:** combined chefs, live instruction, projection, audience participation, and hybrid production into a physical-to-digital food-education format connecting Brooklyn and Sweden.
- **FRIDA001:** connected physical installation, digital 3D artwork, NFC, and AR into one emerging-media art experience.
- **The Nightlight:** School of Visual Arts thesis won Best Production Value, earned a \$1,000 award, received festival recognition, and led directly to a first professional role.

OPERATING RANGE

Live Sports Broadcast: ESPN, NBA, MLB, YES Network, SNY

News & Elections: CNN, CBS, MSNBC, Tribune, PIX11, WGN

AI Products & Storytelling: Fridgie Smalls, FRIDGIE x SCRAPS*

XR / Web3 / Interactive Art: The Metacheese, FRIDA001, SwivelMeta, Outernet, Strevi

Experiential & Hybrid Events: Scrappyhour, The Metacheese, New Year's Rockin' Eve

Launches / Platforms / Systems: Fox Business Network, CBS HD, Vizrt, Lockheed Martin internal multi-touch, real-time control rooms

EDUCATION

BFA, Computer Art | School of Visual Arts, New York, NY

SELECTED LINKS

Portfolio / Scrappy Meals | LinkedIn | Fridgie Smalls | The Metacheese